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Section Title(S): Categories 1 And 2. Kin And Affines

Informants were able to give explanations, as they see them, for prohibition of marriage with the following affines. Why, we had asked, is marriage with WiSiDa and HuBrSo specifically prohibited? #Toma explained that a man often marries his WiSi if his wife should die, or as a second wife. His being her potential husband makes him “feel like” her husband even though he is not married to her. As a result, his WiSiDa seems to him like his own daughter. Similarly, a woman is a potential wife of HuBr, so HuBrSo is like her So.

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Marriage with a SiHuFa or BrWiMo seems improper to the !Kung, because a woman's marriage with a SiHu (as second wife or if her SiHu is a widower) or a man's with a BrWi (if the death or divorce of the brother makes the marriage with BrWi possible) is highly appropriate, and the parents of these affines, therefore, seem to ego “like” his spouse's parents.

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Among the affines ego must not marry are SoWiFa, DaHuFa, SoWiMo, DaHuMo. Marriage with one of these would turn ego's So and SoWi, Da and DaHu into stepbrothers and stepsisters, which would be most awkward.

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Marriage is prohibited with HuSiHu and WiBrWi, termed respectively *#tum* and */ utsu*; ego avoids joking with them as he avoids joking with HuSi and WiBr. Informants had no verbalized explanation for the prohibition of marriage with these affines as they had for some other prohibitions. They simply said marriage with them would be wrong. In other words, the incest taboo is extended to them. I think symmetry in the avoidance of joking is the factor

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through which the incest taboo is extended. Among siblings and their spouses, and among spouse's siblings and their spouses, the prohibition of joking and marriage are seen as [p. 257]

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TABLE 18. Marriage and Joking in the Sibling Category

No asterisk indicates that marriage and joking are prohibited.

Male Ego				Female Ego			
Ego's Siblings and Their Spouses							
Br	!go* or tsi*	BiWi	tūn**	Br	!go or tsi	BrWi	/utsu
Si	!kwi or tsi	SiHu	tūn!ga	Si	!kwi* or tsi*	SiHu	tun!ga**
Ego's Spouse's Siblings and Their Spouses							
WiBr	tūn!ga	WiBrWi	/utsu	HuBr	tūn!ga**	HuBrWi	!kwi* or tsi*
WiSi	tūn**	WiSiHu	!go* or tsi*	HuSi	/utsu	HuSiHu	≠tum

258 coinciding. Opposite sex making marriage possible, ego may marry the affines with whom he may joke and is prohibited from marrying those with whom he avoids joking (see Table 18). I think that, furthermore, the terms ≠tum and / utsu reinforce the feeling among the !Kung that marriage with HuSiHu and WiBrWi would be wrong. These terms are strongly associated with the incest taboo and marriage prohibitions; they are the terms applied to parents of spouse and spouses of offspring.

* Joking is allowed.

** Opposite sex makes marriage possible, and marriage and joking are allowed.

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